INCH-POUND
A-A-55306
January 29, 1997

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

NEEDLE, SAILMAKER'S

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for GGG-N-202 for all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This document covers needles intended to be used by sailmakers for sewing and repairing canvas.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The sailmaker's needles shall be of standard industry size numbers 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 17, and 18.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS. The sailmaker's needles shall be forged or cast steel. All needle surfaces, the eye, and the section of the eye adjacent to the heel shall be smooth and polished. Each needle shall be ground to a fine point. The edges of the triangle section shall be ground and rounded in such a manner that material fibers shall not be cut when pierced by the needle in the normal sewing operation. The eye shall be rounded and so designed that the thread will not be cut when used under ordinary service conditions. The opening of the eye shall be centered between its lateral surfaces. Needles shall be heat treated to meet deflection requirements without a permanent set. The needles shall conform to the dimensions listed in Table I.

Table I. Dimensions and tolerances 1/

Needle size number	Over-all length A ±3/16	B ±5/16	C	D ±1/8	E ±0.005	F ±0.011	G ±0.007	H 2/ ±0.0312
	Inches	Inches	Inch	Inches	Inch	Inch	Inch	Inch
6	5-1/8	3-1/16	.201 ± .016	1-1/2	.189	.204	.138	.417
8	4-9/16	2-5/8	.169 ± .014	1-3/8	.156	.164	.117	.367
10	3-3/4	2	.138 ± .012	1	.127	.134	.097	.344
12	3-3/16	1-13/16	.108 ± .010	7/8	.102	.101	.077	.229
14	2-3/4	1-1/2	.085 ± .008	3/4	.078	.080	.060	.180
16	2-7/16	1-1/4	.068 ± .006	5/8	.063	.064	.047	.166
17	2-5/16	1-1/8	.060 ± .006	9/16	.054	.057	.039	.149
18	2-3/16	1-1/8	.052 ± .004	1/2	.046	.054	.035	.133

1/ See Figure 1
2/ Inside length of needle eye

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DPSC-FNS, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19145-5099.

AMSC N/A FSC 8315

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3.2 Deflection tests. The point end of the needle shall be placed between two pieces of 3/16-inch diameter drill rod, held rigidly by a vise as shown in Figure 2, or by a vise with V block, or by other means. The distances "s" and "d" are shown in Figure 2. The distance "s" between the drill rods shall be as shown in Table II. The tip of the needle shall extend 3/32 inch beyond the point of contact with the drill rod. When the needles are held by other than drill rods, they shall be gripped 7/32 inch maximum from the point of the needle. A force shall be applied to the eye end of the needle, as close as possible to the heel, in a direction that will cause the needle to bend while the point remains stationary. A relatively sharp-edged tool such as a screwdriver or chisel shall be used in applying this force. The heel of each needle shall be deflected a linear distance "d" as specified in Table II. This test shall be performed for each of the three planes represented by the triangular section of each needle. Any permanent set of the needle shall constitute failure of this test.

Table II. Distance and reflection

Needle number	Distance (s)	Distance (d)
	Inch	Inch
6	7/16	9/16
8	7/16	9/16
10	7/16	9/16
12	3/8	5/8
14	3/8	9/16
16	3/8	9/16
17	5/16	9/16
18	5/16	9/16

4. **REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS**. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own standards and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Visual examination. Each needle shall be examined for the defects listed below.

5.2.1 Defects. Surface (including periphery of the eye) is not smooth; evidence of imbedded foreign matter; does not have fine, sharp point; edges of triangular section not ground and rounded; eye not centered between lateral edges; eye is partially or fully closed; sharp edge at eye (inside or outside); burrs or slivers not removed; needle is cracked or broken; evidence of pitholes, nicks, or scratches; measurement of item not as specified; any items not packaged in accordance with the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

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6. PACKAGING

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking. The preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Source of Government documents. Copies of military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Bldg. 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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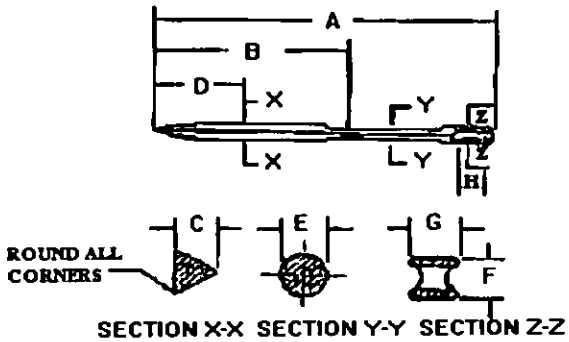


FIGURE 1. SAILMAKER'S NEEDLE

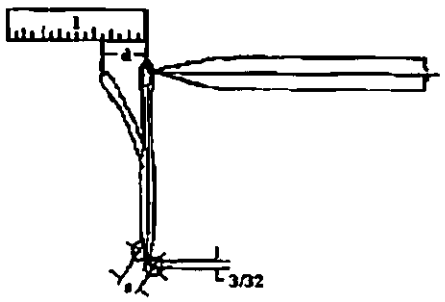


FIGURE 2. DEFLECTION TEST

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